



Figure 6A—"Disktionary" of Desktop Icons

Note!

Hard drives, due to a ProDOS limitation that restricts disk sizes to 32 megabytes, may be displayed as multiple icons. Each icon represents one partition, or division, of the drive, and each is accessed as a separate drive, although physically all the partitions are on one drive.

Note!

Due to the nature of 5.25" drives, the Finder can't tell when you insert a 5.25" disk in a drive (or remove one). Therefore, the Finder displays 5.25" drives separately from the disks that are in them. If you have a 5.25" drive with a disk in it, you'll see two icons for it—a drive icon (called APPLEDISK5.25A) and an icon for the disk itself. If you don't have a disk in the drive, you'll only see the drive icon.

If you're following along, your Finder screen should look something like Figure 6B right now—icons on the right side of the screen, Trash in the lower right corner of the screen, and no windows open. (Your system is probably somewhat different from ours, so you probably won't have exactly the same icons we do.) If you have some windows open, close them by pulling down the File menu and choosing "Close All."

▲ By The Way...

The Finder places the icon of disk you booted from in the upper right corner of the desktop, and places the Trash icon in the lower right corner of the screen.

Icons don't always represent disks. The Finder also uses icons to represent files—collections of information stored on disks. You probably don't see any file icons right now, but you will soon enough. "File" is a generic term; every bit of information stored on your disk is stored in a file of some kind.

Files that contain instructions for the computer are called programs. Programs come in two flavors: system software tells the computer how to behave in general terms; applications tell the computer how to perform a specific task—word processing, for example. (The Finder is a difficult program to categorize in this way; it's an application that comes with the system software and is thus often considered to be system software.)

Files that contain information you (or some other human) entered are called documents. The word "document" does not necessarily imply text or printed material; sound and music files, for example, are also considered documents.